



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



THIS WEEK'S MENU

Parmesan Polenta

with Pan-Seared Chicken & A Savory Pan Sauce

pan-seared chicken breasts & asparagus, mushroom pan sauce, creamy parmesan polenta, chopped chives, freshly ground black pepper

Cornmeal Cutlets

with Pistou Orzo Salad

cornmeal-crusted chicken breast, Parmigiano Reggiano, cannellini beans, orzo, tomatoes, arugula, queso fresco, pistou, balsamic glaze

Balsamic Chicken

with Crispy Polenta Cakes

balsamic marinated-chicken, shallow-fried polenta cakes, tomatoes, arugula, Parmigiano Reggiano, pistou, balsamic glaze, basil, flaky salt

Marinated Fish

with Spring Vegetable Bean Salad

garlic, olive oil, lemon juice, dill, white fish, white wine vinaigrette, cannellini beans, orzo, arugula, asparagus ribbons, chives, dill, queso fresco

Creamy Shrumami Orzotto

with Pan-Seared Salmon

savory mushroom purée, risotto-style orzo, cream, pan-seared salmon fillets, freshly ground black pepper, chopped chives



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Shallot (1)¹⁵
- Garlic (6 cloves)¹²³⁴⁵
- Lemon (2)⁴
- Campari or Cherry Tomatoes (12 oz)²³
- Asparagus (1 large bunch)¹⁴
- Arugula (5 oz)²³⁴
- Basil (1 small bunch / about 1 cup)²³
- Chives (1 bunch)¹²³⁴⁵
- Dill (1 bunch)⁴
- Baby Bella Mushrooms (8 oz)¹⁵
- Shiitake Mushrooms (5 oz)¹⁵

Shelf-Stable Goods

- Pecans, Walnuts, or Almonds (½ cup)²³
- Orzo* (1 ¾ cup)²⁴⁵
- Cannellini Beans (1 x 15 oz can)²⁴
- Medium-Grind Cornmeal (1 ¼ cups)¹²³
- Panko Breadcrumbs (½ cup)²
- Chicken Stock (5 ½ cups)¹³⁵
- Balsamic Glaze (Optional)²³

Eggs & Dairy

- Eggs (1)²
- Heavy Cream (3-5 Tbsp)¹³⁵

Cheese

- Parmigiano Reggiano (6 oz)¹²³⁵
- Queso Fresco (10 oz)²³⁴

Suggested Proteins

- 3 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts¹²³
- 2 (4 oz) White Fish Fillets (Tilapia, Cod, or Halibut)⁴
- 2 (4-6 oz) Salmon Fillets⁵

KEY

¹ = Parmesan Polenta

² = Cornmeal Cutlets

³ = Balsamic Chicken Skewers

⁴ = Marinated Fish

⁵ = Creamy Shrumami Orzotto

*=rollover ingredient



ESSENTIALS

& TIME SAVERS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil¹²³⁴⁵
- Neutral Oil¹²³⁴⁵
- Salted Butter¹³⁵

Acid & Vinegars

- White Wine Vinegar⁴
- Red Wine Vinegar²³
- Balsamic Vinegar³

Spices & Aromatics

- Black Pepper¹²³⁴⁵
- Dried Oregano³

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³⁴⁵
- Brown Sugar³
- Soy Sauce¹⁵
- Honey²³⁴
- All-Purpose Flour²
- Flaky Salt (optional)³⁴

Tools

- 2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers³

Time Savers

Produce

- Pre-Peeled Garlic
 - Garlic (7 cloves)
- Pre-sliced Mushrooms
 - Whole Baby Bella Mushrooms (8 oz)
 - Whole Shiitake Mushrooms (5 oz)

Shelf-Stable

- Balsamic Marinade
 - Balsamic Vinegar
 - Dried Oregano
 - Brown Sugar
 - Garlic (-2 cloves)

KEY

¹ = Parmesan Polenta

² = Cornmeal Cutlets

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⁵ = Creamy Shrimami Orzotto

Red = Subtract if using Time Saver



PREP LIST



KEY

- ¹ = Parmesan Polenta
- ² = Cornmeal Cutlets
- ³ = Balsamic Chicken Skewers
- ⁴ = Marinated Fish
- ⁵ = Creamy Shrumami Orzotto

 = used in "prepped ingredient"

 = estimated time

Green = keep out during prep

- ☐ Preheat oven to 350°F
- ☐ Prep Produce ( 30 minutes)
 - Arugula (wash & dry and/or transfer to container with paper towel)²³⁴
 - Asparagus (½ bunch; ribbons⁴ | ½ bunch; trim the bottoms¹)
 - Mushrooms (Shiitake; thinly slice | Baby Bella; thinly slice)
 - Lemons (2; slice in half)⁴
 - Herbs
 - Basil (1 cup; remove from stems, wash, & dry)³
 - Dill (1 bunch; chop)⁴
 - Chives (1 bunch; thinly slice)¹²³⁴
 - Garlic (6 cloves; peel)⁴
 - Shallot (1; finely dice)
- ☐ Toast Nuts (½ cup or 75 g | toast for 15 minutes) 
- ☐ Bring a pot of water up to a boil (for Orzo)²⁴

CLEANING BREAK

- ☐ Strain, rinse, & put away Cannellini Beans²⁴
- ☐ Start Shrumami Sauce (see PDF 'Shrumami Base' steps 1-2)¹⁵
- ☐ Boil 1 cup of Orzo²⁴
- ☐ Grate 6 oz Parmesan (place in a blender to expedite the process)¹²³⁵
- ☐ Crumble 10 oz Queso Fresco²³⁴
- ☐ Start Polenta Base (see PDF 'Polenta Base')¹³
- ☐ Prepare Sauces ( 35 minutes)
 - Finish Shrumami Base (see PDF 'Shrumami Base' step 3)¹⁵
 - Pistou (see PDF 'Pistou')²³
 - Balsamic Marinade (see PDF 'Balsamic Marinade')³

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

- ☐ Chicken Breasts (1 large; diced into 1 ½" pieces³ | 2 large; sliced in half lengthwise¹²)
 - Store each breast of chicken separately in airtight bags in the freezer; The night before intended use, transfer to the refrigerator to thaw overnight



PARMESAN POLENTA WITH CHICKEN & A SAVORY PAN SAUCE

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Polenta Base (Page 6)¹³

Shrumami Base (Page 8)¹⁵

Parmesan Polenta

$\frac{2}{3}$ batch of Polenta Base

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup Chicken Stock

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup shredded Parmigiano Reggiano

1 Tbsp Salted Butter

1 Tbsp Extra-Virgin Olive Oil

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Chicken & Asparagus

1 large (8-9 oz) Chicken Breast, sliced in half
(lengthwise)

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Olive Oil

12-14 Asparagus Spears

Savory Pan Sauce

Olive Oil

$\frac{1}{2}$ batch of Shrumami Base

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup Stock (Chicken or Vegetable)

2 Tbsp cold Salted Butter, cubed

1-2 Tbsp Heavy Cream (Optional)

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Chopped Chives, *for garnish*

Instructions

Reheat the Polenta

1. Place the **polenta base** and **chicken stock** in a medium saucepan over medium-low heat and whisk until combined. Once the polenta is smooth, bring the heat up to medium-high and cook until the polenta thickens, about 5-7 minutes.

Hot Tip: While the polenta thickens, prepare the chicken.

2. Once the polenta has thickened, and right before serving, whisk in **Parmigiano Reggiano**, **butter**, **olive oil**, and **salt**, to taste.

Prepare the Pan-Seared Chicken

1. Season **chicken** halves generously with **salt** and **pepper**.
2. Heat a few glugs of **oil** in a large sauté pan over medium-high heat. Add the seasoned chicken breasts and sear, without touching, for 2-3 minutes. Flip the chicken and cook for an additional 2-3 minutes. Transfer both pieces of seared chicken to a plate and set aside.
3. In the now-empty pan, add another slug of oil, followed by the **asparagus** and a pinch of **salt**. Cook, flipping every 1-2 minutes, until tender, around 4 minutes. Transfer the asparagus to a plate, garnish with **freshly ground black pepper**, and set aside.

Prepare the Savory Pan Sauce & Serve

1. In the same sauté pan used for the chicken and asparagus, heat a slug of **olive oil** over medium heat.
2. Stir in the **shrumami base** and cook until sizzling, about 1-2 minutes. Whisk in the **stock** until fully emulsified, and cook over medium-high heat for 2-3 minutes. Add the **cold butter**, and whisk until fully incorporated. Finish the sauce by whisking in the **heavy cream** (optional), a pinch of **salt**, and a generous amount of **freshly ground black pepper**. Reduce the heat to low, add the chicken back in, and cook until the sauce is thick and the chicken reaches an internal temperature of 165°F.
3. Plate the shrumami pan sauce and top with parmesan polenta and asparagus. Place the seared chicken on top and garnish with **chopped chives** and additional pepper.

CORNMEAL CUTLETS WITH PISTOU ORZO SALAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Pistou (Page 7)²³

Cornmeal Cutlet

1 large (8-9 oz) Chicken Breast, sliced in half or thirds (lengthwise)

1/3 cup All-Purpose Flour

1 Egg

1/2 cup Panko Breadcrumbs

1/4 cup Cornmeal

2 Tbsp Parmigiano Reggiano

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Neutral Oil, *for cooking*

Pistou Orzo Salad

1/2 can of Cannellini Beans, strained & rinsed

1 1/2 cups cooked Orzo

3 Campari Tomatoes (quartered) or 10-12 Cherry Tomatoes (halved)

2 oz (roughly 2 handfuls) of Arugula

1/4 cup crumbled Queso Fresco

2-3 heaping Tbsp Pistou

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Balsamic Glaze, *for garnish* (Optional)

Chopped Chives, *for garnish*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *for garnish*

Instructions

Assemble the Cornmeal Cutlets

1. Pat **chicken breast** dry with a paper towel before placing it in a shallow bowl. In the same shallow bowl, coat the chicken with **flour** and a pinch of **salt**.
2. In a separate shallow bowl, whisk the **egg**; in a final shallow bowl, combine **panko breadcrumbs, cornmeal, Parmigiano Reggiano**, a generous pinch of **salt**, and **pepper**.
3. Coat the chicken breasts in flour, then place in the egg mixture, fully coating both sides. Transfer the egg-coated chicken breast into the breadcrumb-cornmeal mixture, pressing the breadcrumbs onto the surface of the chicken breast.
4. Heat enough **neutral oil** to cover the bottom of a large cast-iron skillet over medium heat (*oil filling 1/4 inch up the side of the pan preferred*).
5. Once the oil reaches 375°F to 400°F, add chicken cutlets. Cook cutlets on both sides until golden brown and crispy, around 3 to 4 minutes per side. Once the internal temperature of the chicken reaches 165°F, transfer each cutlet to a paper towel-lined plate and season with a pinch of salt.
6. Allow the chicken to rest for 3-4 minutes before serving.

Hot Tip: While chicken rests, prepare pistou orzo salad.

Prepare the Pistou Orzo Salad & Plate

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine **beans, orzo, tomatoes, arugula, queso fresco, pistou**, and a generous pinch of **salt**—mix well.
2. Plate the orzo salad and top with the cornmeal cutlets. Garnish with **chopped chives, balsamic glaze** (optional), and **freshly ground black pepper**.

BALSAMIC CHICKEN SKEWERS WITH CRISPY POLENTA CAKES

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Pistou (Page 7)²³

Balsamic Marinade (Page 9)³

Polenta Base (Page 6)¹³

Balsamic Chicken Skewers & Crispy Polenta

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast, diced
into 1" to 1 1/2" pieces

1 batch Balsamic Marinade

Neutral Oil

2 (8-inch) Wooden or Metal Skewers

1/3 batch (or remaining) Polenta Base

Kosher Salt

Arugula Salad

2 Campari Tomatoes (sliced into quarters) or 8-10 Cherry
Tomatoes (sliced in half)

1 oz (about 1 handful) Arugula

1/4 cup Queso Fresco

1 heaping Tbsp of shredded Parmigiano Reggiano

Olive Oil

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, plus more *for garnish*

Pistou (remaining)

Flaky Salt, *for garnish* (Optional)

Balsamic Glaze, *for garnish* (Optional)

Basil Leaves, *for garnish* (Optional)

Instructions

Marinate the Chicken & Bring the Pistou to Room Temp

1. At least 15 minutes or up to 4 hours before cooking, place the **chicken breast** and **balsamic marinade** in a bowl and stir until well combined. Marinate at room temperature for 15 minutes (*if marinating for longer than 15 minutes*, cover and marinate in the refrigerator for up to 4 hours).
2. Remove the **pistou** from the refrigerator and set it aside on the counter (*preferably in the sunlight*, bringing it to room temperature quickly).
3. Preheat grill to 400°F and grease with **neutral oil**.
4. Thread the marinated chicken onto **skewers** (about 6-7 pieces of chicken per skewer) and set aside.

Assemble Polenta Cakes & Cook Chicken

1. Lightly grease your hands with **olive oil**, and form 4 even **polenta** patties/cakes (*they should resemble mini hockey pucks*). Place the polenta cakes on a plate and set aside.
2. Place the chicken skewers on the preheated grill and cook for 16-18 minutes, *flipping every 5-6 minutes to prevent burning*.

Hot Tip: While chicken cooks, return to the stove to cook the polenta cakes.

3. Heat a thin layer of **neutral oil** in a skillet. Once the oil is hot, add the polenta cakes and cook for 5-6 minutes, flipping halfway. Transfer the polenta cakes to a paper towel-lined plate and season with **kosher salt**. Return to the grill to check on the chicken.
4. Once the largest piece of chicken reaches an internal temperature of 165°F, transfer the skewers to a plate, lightly sprinkle with a pinch of **flaky salt**, and loosely cover with foil. Rest for 5 minutes before serving.

Hot Tip: While your chicken rests, prepare the Arugula Salad.

Prepare the Arugula Salad & Assemble the Dish

1. In a medium mixing bowl, combine **tomatoes**, **arugula**, **queso fresco**, **Parmigiano Reggiano**, a **light drizzle of olive oil**, **salt**, and **pepper**. Toss until well combined.
2. Plate the arugula salad and top it with crispy polenta cakes and chicken skewers. Garnish with a few spoonfuls of room temperature **pistou**, a pinch of **flaky salt** (optional), **balsamic glaze** (optional), and **basil leaves** (optional).

MARINATED FISH

WITH SPRING VEGETABLE BEAN SALAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Marinated Fish

1 Tbsp chopped Dill
Juice of ½ Lemon
2 Tbsp Olive Oil
2 cloves of Garlic, grated
½ tsp Kosher Salt
¼ tsp Freshly Ground Black Pepper
2 (4 oz) White Fish Fillets (Halibut, Cod, Tilapia, etc)

Spring Vegetable-Bean Salad

Juice of ½ a Lemon
1 Tbsp White Wine Vinegar
3-4 Tbsp Olive Oil
1 tsp Honey
Kosher Salt, *to taste*
½ can of Cannellini Beans, strained & rinsed
½ cup cooked Orzo
2 oz (or 2 large handfuls) Arugula
½ bunch of Asparagus, shaved into ribbons
1 Tbsp Chopped Chives
1 Tbsp Chopped Dill
¼ cup crumbled Queso Fresco
Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*
Flaky Salt, *for garnish* (Optional)

Instructions

Marinate & Cook the Fish

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
2. In a shallow bowl or quarter sheet tray, whisk together **dill, lemon juice, olive oil, grated garlic, salt, and pepper**. Place the **white fish fillets** in the marinade and coat, using your hands. Let the fillets marinate in the refrigerator for at least 15 minutes (and up to 4 hours).
3. Once the fish has marinated, place the fillets on a parchment-lined baking sheet, sprinkle each fillet with a small pinch of kosher salt, and bake for 10-11 minutes.

Prepare the Spring Vegetable Bean Salad

1. In a large mixing bowl, whisk together **lemon juice, vinegar, olive oil, honey** and **kosher salt**. Once mixed, add **beans, orzo, arugula, shaved asparagus, chives, dill, queso fresco,** and **freshly ground black pepper**. Taste and season with additional salt and/or a splash of vinegar, to taste. Place the salad in the refrigerator, while you wait for the fish to finish cooking (if applicable).

Hot Tip: If the salad tastes slightly dull, add a small pinch of salt at a time, followed by a small splash of white wine vinegar and mix—the salad should taste bright, herbaceous, and flavorful.

2. Plate the bean salad and top with the cooked white fish. Garnish with additional chopped dill, chives, black pepper, and **flaky salt** (optional).

CREAMY SHRUMAMI ORZOTTO

WITH PAN-SEARED SALMON

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Shrumami Base (Page 8)^{1s}

Creamy Mushroom Orzo

Olive Oil

½ batch of Shrumami Base

¾ cup of Orzo (uncooked)

3-3 ¼ cups Stock (Chicken or Vegetable), divided

1 Tbsp Salted Butter

1 Tbsp Heavy Cream (Optional)

2 Tbsp shredded Parmigiano Reggiano

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Pan-Seared Salmon

2 (4 oz) Salmon Fillets

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Neutral Oil, *for cooking*

1 Tbsp Salted Butter

Chopped Chives, *for garnish*

Instructions

Prepare the Creamy Mushroom Orzo

1. Heat a few glugs of **olive oil** in a large saucepan over medium-high heat. Once the oil is hot and shimmering, add **shrumami base** and sauté for about 1 minute, until fragrant.
2. Stir in **orzo**, followed by **¼ cup stock**. Reduce the heat to medium and cook, occasionally stirring, until the stock is fully absorbed. Repeat this process—*stirring in ¼ cup of stock and cooking until fully absorbed*—until all 3 cups of stock have been used. This process should take around 20-23 minutes. *If necessary*, use the **remaining ¼ cup of stock**, adding about a tablespoon at a time until the orzo reaches your desired consistency.

Hot Tip: In the final 4-5 minutes of cooking your orzotto, prepare the salmon for a well-timed plating.

3. Once the orzotto is fully cooked, turn off the heat and stir in the **butter, heavy cream** (optional), and **Parmigiano Reggiano**, mixing until smooth and creamy.
4. Season with **salt** and **pepper** to taste.

Sear the Salmon & Serve

1. Season **salmon fillets** with **salt** and **pepper**. Set aside.
2. Heat a medium pan over high heat and add **neutral oil**.
3. Place the seasoned salmon fillets presentation-side facing down into the pan. Cook until golden and crisp, then flip and finish cooking to your preferred doneness.—in the last minute of cooking, add **salted butter** and baste over the salmon, using a spoon.
4. Plate the orzotto and top with the seared salmon. Garnish with **chopped chives** and freshly ground black pepper.

POLENTA BASE

Makes about 4 servings

Ingredients

2 ½ cups Stock (Chicken or Vegetable)
2 ½ cups Water
1 cup Medium-Grind Cornmeal
1 tsp Kosher Salt (divided), *plus more to taste*
2 Tbsp Heavy Cream
2 Tbsp Salted Butter

Instructions

1. Place **stock** and **water** in a large pot and bring to a boil. While whisking, add **cornmeal**, ½ **tsp of salt**, and reduce the heat to medium.
2. Cook the polenta, while whisking every 6-7 minutes, until it begins to thicken (around 20-25 minutes)*.

Hot Tip: Whisking will help prevent the polenta from sticking to the bottom of the pan and burning.

***IMPORTANT NOTE:** If using a coarse or fine cornmeal (not medium-grind) cook times may differ. To test for doneness, rub a small amount of polenta between your fingers and feel for any hard grains--if you feel them, it needs to cook longer. If it's smooth and silky, it's ready! If your polenta base is undercooked, it leads to the corn not gelatinizing enough to hold its shape when frying on Day 3.

3. Once the polenta starts to resemble a thick paste, turn the heat to low and stir in the remaining ½ **tsp of salt**, **heavy cream**, and **butter**. Taste and season with additional salt, *if needed*. Turn off the heat completely and let the polenta rest for 5-10 minutes to thicken.

To Store: Transfer the polenta to a sheet tray and spread it into a thin layer. Allow the polenta to cool down slightly before covering with plastic wrap and placing the sheet tray in the refrigerator to cool completely.

PISTOU

Makes about 1 cup

Ingredients

½ cup (75 g) raw Pecans, Walnuts, or Almonds
1 cup (30 g) tightly packed Basil Leaves
1 clove of Garlic
½ cup (90 g) Olive Oil
1 Tbsp (15 g) Red Wine Vinegar
1 Tbsp (21 g) Honey
¾ tsp (3 g) Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. Preheat your oven to 350°F.
2. Place **nuts (pecans, walnuts, or almonds)** on a baking sheet and toast for 10-15 minutes. Allow the nuts to cool completely.

Hot Tip: Failure to allow nuts to cool completely before cooling might lead to a nut spread consistency (which we don't want).

3. Using an immersion blender or food processor, blend cooled nuts, **basil, garlic, olive oil, vinegar, honey,** and **salt**, until mostly blended (a few small chunks are fine!).

To Store: Place the pistou in an airtight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

SHRUMAMI BASE

Makes roughly 1 cup

Ingredients

Neutral Oil

5 oz Shiitake Mushrooms, thinly sliced

8 oz Baby Bella Mushrooms, thinly sliced

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

1 Shallot, finely diced

2 cloves of Garlic, grated

2 Tbsp Salted Butter

1 tsp Soy Sauce

½ cup Stock (Chicken or Vegetable)

Instructions

1. Heat **neutral oil** in a large skillet over high heat. Add **both mushrooms** and sauté for 5-6 minutes, stirring occasionally.
2. Once the mushrooms have cooked down and are slightly caramelized, add a generous pinch of **salt** and stir. Using a wooden spoon, move the mushrooms to the side of the skillet and add a few glugs of neutral oil to the now-empty side. Add **shallots** and a pinch of salt, and sauté until soft and translucent, around 2-3 minutes. Add **grated garlic** and sauté just until fragrant. Stir all of the ingredients together, then add **butter**, and **soy sauce**. Reduce the heat to medium-low and cook until the mushrooms and shallots are soft and slightly deeper in color, around 2-3 minutes.
3. Transfer the cooked mushroom mixture and **stock** to a blender or a vessel compatible with an immersion blender and blend until mostly smooth. Taste and season with additional salt, *if needed*.

To Store: Place the shrumami base in an air-tight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.

BALSAMIC MARINADE

Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup (140 g) Balsamic Vinegar

$\frac{1}{4}$ cup (40 g) Olive Oil

1 Tbsp (15 g) Brown Sugar

1 tsp (4 g) Kosher Salt

$\frac{1}{2}$ tsp (<1 g) Dried Oregano

2 cloves of Garlic, grated

Instructions

1. Whisk **all ingredients** until fully combined.

To Store: Transfer to an airtight container and store it in the refrigerator for later use.